

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Layered society, not a court-peasant binary

EMPEROR / HOUSEHOLD -> sovereignty, patronage and concentrated consumption

MANSABDARS / CHIEFS -> service rank, local power and armed followings

MERCHANTS / PROFESSIONALS -> credit, brokerage, law, medicine and records

ARTISANS / SERVICE GROUPS -> skilled and ordinary production

CULTIVATORS / LABOURERS -> unequal land, cattle, credit and customary claims

RULE -> hierarchy was real, but region, occupation and mobility varied.

MUST REMEMBER: Peasants, zamindars, artisans, merchants and nobles occupied unequal positions within an agrarian-commercial economy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Nobility: mansab, household and reproduction

MANSAB -> appointed zat status-pay plus sawar cavalry obligation

HOUSEHOLD -> kin, clients, retainers, scribes, soldiers and dependants

COMPOSITE ELITE -> Turani, Irani, Hindustani, Rajput, Afghan and Deccani labels

FORMAL RULE -> rank is not automatically hereditary

SOCIAL FACT -> khanazad advantage, patronage and training reproduce position

TRAP -> ancestry labels do not prove every noble was foreign-born.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Zamindars across a spectrum

VILLAGE END -> locally rooted claimant with information and customary dues

MIDDLE -> armed lineage, garhi, caste-clan following and several villages

RAJA END -> substantial territorial chief incorporated or negotiated with

STATE NEED -> collection, order, settlement and local mediation

CONFLICT -> regulation, resistance and mansab incorporation can coexist

TRAP -> neither mere tax clerk nor uniform British-style landlord.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Cultivators and layered rights

KHUD-KASHT -> resident cultivator, often with stronger local resources

PAHI-KASHT -> incoming or non-resident cultivator, often drawn by concession

RAIYATI / MUZARIAN -> varied ordinary cultivator or tenant contexts

RIGHTS -> labour, occupancy, inheritance, revenue and customary access overlap

MEDIATORS -> patil, muqaddam, qanungo, patwari and desh mukh vary by region

TRAP -> layered claims are not simple modern private landownership.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Women, work and source silence

WORK -> agriculture, spinning, embroidery and domestic production

ELITE EVIDENCE -> Gulbadan, Nur Jahan and Jahanara show particular agency

ARCHIVE BIAS -> court texts record elite women more readily than ordinary labour

MATERIAL / IMAGE -> can suggest practice but cannot serve as an occupation census

CONSTRAINTS -> caste, class, marriage, purdah, property and credit vary

VERDICT -> differentiated agency within a strongly unequal gender order.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Towns and the middle strata

IMPERIAL CITY -> court, garrison, workshops and consumption

PORT CITY -> customs, shipping, brokers and overseas exchange

QASBA -> administration, learning, market and countryside link

PRODUCTION / PILGRIMAGE CENTRE -> specialised craft or religious demand

MIDDLE STRATA -> clerks, qazis, physicians, shopkeepers and master-craftsmen

RESULT -> urban diversity corrects Bernier's noble-versus-poor binary.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Karkhana and craft production

INPUTS -> cotton, silk, dyes, metals, stone, timber and skilled labour

KARKHANA -> imperial household store and workshop, not every private workshop

ORGANISATION -> masters, artisans, wage/service ties and quality control

PRIVATE FIELD -> household craft, merchant advance and putting-out coexist

OUTPUT -> textiles, arms, jewellery, ships, books, paintings and monuments

LIMIT -> court production cannot measure all craft labour or welfare.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Inland trade, hundi and banjara

ROAD / RIVER / SARAI -> movement, rest, information and state oversight
BANJARA -> bulk overland carriage, especially grain and army supply
HUNDI -> credit instrument moving value across distance and time
SARRAF -> money changing, testing and finance | BROKER -> market access
AURANG -> warehouse or depot | BANIAN -> company-linked Indian agent-broker
RESULT -> goods, credit and information connect town, port and countryside.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Overseas trade, companies and bullion

PORTS -> Surat / Cambay, Hugli / Balasore, Masulipatnam / Pulicat

EXPORTS -> textiles, silk, indigo, sugar, grain and saltpetre vary by region

IMPORTS -> horses, metals and luxuries; bullion helps settle trade balances

INDIAN AGENCY -> Virji Vohra, Abdul Ghaffur and merchant communities

COMPANIES -> enter existing networks while naval-coercive capacity grows

TRAP -> bullion is not welfare; company presence is not instant dominance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Technology without stagnation or industrial teleology

STRENGTH -> textiles, dyes, jewellery, shipbuilding and craft precision

SELECTIVE LIMIT -> pumps, furnaces, screws, optics and some machine linkages

PRINT DISTINCTION -> textile blocks, known presses and uneven institutional uptake

POSSIBLE CAUSES -> labour cost, investment choice and weak science-craft linkage

METHOD -> compare sector, institution, date and diffusion

VERDICT -> high skill with uneven adoption; neither no technology nor industry.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Monetisation and long-distance trade coexisted with coercion, subsistence risk and marked regional variation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Culture as institutional and composite production

ARCHITECTURE -> Humayun's Tomb -> Fatehpur -> Taj -> Red Fort

PAINTING -> Akbar's workshop / Hamzanama -> Jahangir / Mansur -> dispersion

LITERATURE -> Persian chronicles, memoirs, malfuzat and vernacular fields

TRANSLATION -> Razmnama; Nizamuddin Panipati's Yogavasistha under Akbar

DARA -> Majma-ul-Bahrain and Sirr-i-Akbar are distinct works

QUALIFY -> cultural interaction did not erase caste, gender or coercion.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Bernier, court chronicles and Mughal painting reveal positioned observations,
not a complete social census.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 24 final answer spine

OPEN -> productive and connected, yet hierarchical and regionally uneven

SOCIETY -> mansab household + zamindar spectrum + layered cultivator rights

ECONOMY -> agrarian surplus -> towns / craft -> credit -> inland / ocean trade

CULTURE -> patronage and workshops convert resources into material forms

METHOD -> named source or monument -> claim -> reach -> silence / limitation

CLOSE -> dynamism was real; prosperity, equality and industrialisation were not universal.